

ACTIVITY 7

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES AND EXPECTATIONS:

Canada and World Issues

UC3.01

TASK:

Your students will learn about the working conditions in the factories where their clothing is produced.

EXPECTATIONS:

The student will:

- Evaluate the role your students play in the global economy.

TIMEFRAME:

5 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

Knowledge / Understanding

Thinking / Inquiry

Communication

Application / Making Connections

MATERIALS:

World map, post-it notes

VOCABULARY:

Sweatshops



The Clothes on your Back

Procedure

1. In partners, ask your students to check the label on an article of clothing of their partner to see where it came from.
2. Have your students write the countries where their clothing was made on a post-it note (1 post-it note per item).
3. When everyone is finished, have the partners place their post-it notes over the country on the map where their clothing was produced.
4. Ask your students to comment on the mapping of their clothing (i.e. where production is concentrated).
5. Ask your students to discuss the working conditions in the factories where their clothing was produced (refer to the background section of this module for information on the garment industry).
6. Refer to the Maquila Solidarity Network's wage card (Supplementary Sheet 9) to examine how much the worker earns to produce the clothes sold in retail stores across North America. How do the workers' wages compare with the cost of the garment that we pay for in the stores?